



Embracing Thunderbolt 3

Intel is trying to push adoption of its Thunderbolt 3 hardware interface on all devices
<http://digit.in/allUSBC>



New plans on Vodafone

Vodafone announces SuperDay, SuperWeek recharge plans starting at ₹19 offering unlimited calling and data benefits. <http://digit.in/superVoda>



Customized 3D Printed Phone Cover

3D Print your own custom designed smartphone cover

Sameet Raut | Imaginarium | feedback@digit.in

U

sing a cover with your smartphone is something quite normal these days - what with phones

falling and breaking into pieces being one of the worst modern nightmares. But since when has something normal been of any interest to the Digit geek? We swear, if we see one more Angry Birds smartphone cover, there'll be exploding black bomb birds all over! Rather than go with the run-of-the-mill smartphone covers being sold on every nook and corner, how about making your own design and then 3D

printing it? Let's see how you can get it done, thanks to the awesome folks over at Imaginarium.

STEP 1

IDEATION

So you want to make a personalized phone cover designed specifically for your phone. As a first step, it is always a good idea to make a sketch on paper to represent what you exactly want. Trust us, this helps a lot in maintaining the same vision throughout the actual implementation, which is something you need for any DIY project.

STEP 2

DESIGN

Approach 1 - Design From Scratch

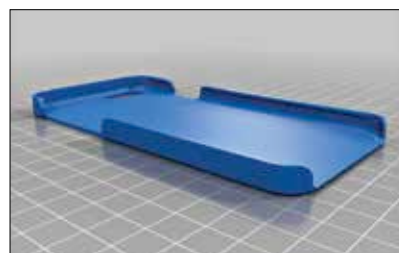
If you have a background in engineering or design, you can easily measure the dimensions of your phone using a Vernier Calliper, and create a corresponding virtual 3D design on your computer, with the help of design software. When taking this approach, you have to keep in mind all the necessary gaps and windows that you need to leave for things like the charging port, the headphone jack, volume buttons, power button, camera lens and more. And you also have to generally leave some allowance for flexing, when fitting the phone into the case.

Not an expert in graphic design? Don't worry, you can still have your own 3D printed personalized phone cover.

Approach 2 - Use An Open Source Design

A lot of websites have a library of 3D designs of various objects, including phone covers. These designs are open source and anyone can download them for personal use. Two very good options for such websites are Thingiverse and Grabcad.

Say you own an iPhone 6 and want to 3D print a personalized cover for it.



You can download the 3D CAD designs for various objects, including most leading smartphone covers from Thingiverse.

Log on to Thingiverse and search for an iPhone 6 cover. Select one of the designs as shown and download it as a .STL (standard triangulation language) file, the format accepted by most 3D printers.